

Yin & Yang One-Page: Everyday Examples

The single idea underneath every school of Chinese metaphysics.

Yin 陰 / Yang 陽 in One Breath

Yang = outward, active, bright, rising. Yin = inward, receptive, still, gathering. Neither is better — each is the other's partner in a cycle.

Everyday Examples

- Day (yang) / night (yin).
- Inhale (yang, expanding) / exhale (yin, settling).
- Summer (yang, blaze) / winter (yin, storing).
- Speaking (yang) / listening (yin).
- Action (yang) / rest (yin).

The Classic Line

“One yin, one yang — this is called the Way.” — Zhou Yi, Xi Ci (繫辭). A chart, a year, a personality: each is some particular balance of the two forces at a given moment.